

## ANGEL ACTION · TRAUMA

# Electric Shock

Never touch the person until the power is off. Once safe, follow DRSABCD, call 000, treat burns and shock. Even a person who seems fine after electric shock should be assessed at hospital.

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## Safety first

- **Do NOT touch the person until the power source is OFF.** Electricity can travel through them and through you.
- Turn off the power at the mains or unplug the appliance.
- For high-voltage power lines (e.g. fallen wires), **stay at least 8 metres away** and call **000** — only emergency services can make the area safe.

## Once safe

1. Follow **DRSABCD**.
2. **Call 000**.
3. If unresponsive and not breathing normally, start **CPR** and attach an **AED**.
4. Cool any **burns** under cool running water for at least 20 minutes — there are often **entry and exit burns**.
5. Treat for **shock**.
6. Always go to hospital, even if the person seems well — internal damage and heart rhythm problems can develop later.

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*Adapted from Australian First Aid 5th Edition. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at [firstaidangel.org](https://firstaidangel.org).*